

Chapter 95_2 - Don't Be Afraid

Although the food wasn't delicious, it was at least edible, and Su Mo was used to eating chaff and swallowing vegetables, so she wasn't picky.

Ning Fuyi watched through the window as Su Mo lowered her head to eat meat. For some reason, her eyes became teary, and the dappled light and shadows became blurred.

Afterward, she silently closed the window and went to the riverside, strolling along the green riverbank for half a day. She even used the clear river water to bathe the gardenia flowers.

Having stayed in the murky demon realm for too long, now sitting again amid green mountains and beautiful waters, watching the lush grass and flowing streams of the human world, she felt even the wind had slowed down.

Ning Fuyi was afraid of disturbing Su Mo, so she didn't return until dusk had fallen and the evening glow had faded.

Su Mo's room was pitch black, and she didn't know if she had rested. The town wasn't prosperous and had no evening market lights, so people here slept very early.

Ning Fuyi also entered another small room, ruffled the grass mat, and lay down fully clothed, following the local customs.

However, shortly after she closed her eyes, she heard the crisp sound of an oil lamp falling from next door. She quickly turned and opened the door, her toes instantly stepping outside the room as she nervously knocked: "Su Mo?"

The room was silent. Ning Fuyi clicked her tongue, almost forgetting that Su Mo couldn't hear. What use was knocking? So she simply climbed through the side window.

By moonlight, she saw no one on the bed, but a piece of clothing hem was visible at the corner where the wooden cabinet was placed. She picked up the oil lamp from the ground, along with half a pot of lamp oil, and lit the oil lamp.

Orange-yellow firelight spilled into the room, illuminating the small house with alternating light and shadow, dispelling the cold darkness.

Only then did she walk to the corner in the lamplight and reach out to pull open the cabinet. Su Mo was indeed curled up there, like a cat with bristled fur, even her feet strictly hidden under her clothing hem, unwilling to be exposed.

She saw Ning Fuyi, and even with the comforting firelight, she still shivered for a moment, her petal-like eyes full of fear that couldn't be hidden.

Ning Fuyi bit her lip, turning to look for more light, but felt a slight weight on her clothing hem. She suddenly stopped and looked down.

Two fingers were grasping her black clothing hem, the fingertips covered with calluses and scars - some healed, some still showing traces of blood.

She seemed quite frightened, even her fingernails were trembling.

Su Mo didn't speak, but Ning Fuyi knew she wanted her not to leave. Her heart tightened slightly as she turned and squatted down. Su Mo didn't move, so she also sat with her, until the lamplight began to flicker and dance, and Su Mo finally supported herself on the wooden cabinet to stand up.

Her willow-like body floated past in front of her. Ning Fuyi wanted to hug her for comfort but didn't move, instead lifting her legs to follow behind, watching her shrink back onto the bed.

Ning Fuyi keenly noticed that before Su Mo crawled under the covers, she fearfully glanced once at the roof beams.

Ning Fuyi followed her gaze to the roof beams, where the light couldn't reach - dark and gloomy, but there was nothing there.

Ning Fuyi suspiciously withdrew her gaze, said nothing more, but set up a barrier with a backhand gesture.

"Sleep, I won't leave," Ning Fuyi said as she pulled over a chair to sit down. "If you're still afraid, I'll go get more lamps."

Su Mo's lower half was covered by the bedding, only her eyes exposed. She extended her thumb and bent it twice: "Thank you."

Hearing this, Ning Fuyi curved her lips, placing her right palm facing Su Mo and waving it left and right, then raising both hands upward, gently shaking: "You're welcome."

Su Mo opened her eyes in surprise, her gaze falling on Ning Fuyi's palms, her eyelashes blinking several times.

"How is it? I just learned this," Ning Fuyi said, seeking praise as she curved her eyebrows.

Su Mo's feet under the bedding moved restlessly. Not daring to look at Ning Fuyi anymore, she closed her eyes, wanting to sleep.

However, after only an incense stick's time¹, she again sprang up from the bed drenched in sweat and curled into the corner, the amplitude of her movement so great that she seemed to have suffered another extremely terrifying fright.

This time she didn't cry out, but instead reached her hand under her veil, biting hard on her own hand to prevent herself from crying aloud.

Seeing this, Ning Fuyi couldn't care about much else. She hurriedly pulled several candles from her sleeves and lit them one by one. Only after the entire room was filled with bright candlelight did she turn to look at Su Mo.

Su Mo was also looking at her, tears soaking her veil, her crying soft.

She hadn't expected Chu Qingqiu² to have such a pitiable moment. Her tears rivaled the river water outside. Ning Fuyi's heart completely softened. She stepped forward, bent down, and wiped away several drops of tears for her.

When her fingertips felt the wetness, the body in front obviously wanted to retreat, but there was a wall behind her - Su Mo couldn't escape.

"Can you tell me what's really wrong? Maybe I can help you," Ning Fuyi's voice was like wind coming through window cracks, warm and soft.

Su Mo now believed she was a good person. What remained was the fear accumulated over many years. Her chest trembled with her sobs as she slowly reached out and touched her veil.

Then she closed her eyes, and the veil was removed by herself. Her face, which had not seen daylight for years, was as white as cooked egg whites, her eyebrows and eyes exactly the same as in her previous life.

Ning Fuyi unconsciously clenched her fingertips, her gaze following the falling veil. When she saw that thing, her hair nearly stood on end, numbness spreading from head to toe.

It was a scarlet birthmark, but not an ordinary birthmark. The red skin formed an enchanting skull flower³ that made one's heart turn cold just looking at it.

Skull flower blooming, eyes connecting yin and yang⁴.

To put it bluntly, it was a naturally different body, bearing the fate of attracting evil spirits with a mortal frame. To put it more simply, it was the legendary **yin-yang eyes**⁵.

Chu Qingqiu was already extremely afraid of ghosts. Now in her reincarnation, she bore such a supernatural birthmark. One really didn't know how much heaven hated her to carve all pain and fear into one person's body.

Su Mo was even more panicked at this moment. She knew how terrifying yin-yang eyes were in the eyes of the world. People born with such evil things would definitely be dragged to the execution ground and burned alive if others found out. Her parents had repeatedly warned her while alive that no matter what happened, she must never remove her veil or tell others.

Now she was extremely afraid, so afraid she dared not open her eyes. She feared the woman in front of her was only pretending to be kind, coming here just to burn her to death. She also feared the woman was truly kind, but mortals most feared evil spirits and fierce ghosts - seeing her appearance, she might be so frightened as to flee in the night.

But after waiting a long time, there was only silence from the other side. Finally, Su Mo forced her eyes open, only to see the woman with cold and sharp features was already covered in tears, crying like a wronged child.

Before Su Mo could react, the woman extended her long arms and drew her into a soft, warm embrace. Those hands held her tightly, so tight it was suffocating.

"Wuuuuuuu..." Ning Fuyi said.

Author's Note:

This story is also known as: Little Crybaby Demon Lord and Big Crybaby Divine Venerable Fall in Love - A Few Matters.

Footnotes

1. **Incense stick's time (一炷香的时辰)** - Traditional Chinese time measurement, approximately 30 minutes to 1 hour
2. **Chu Qingqiu (褚清秋)** - Su Mo's true name from her previous life, the Divine Venerable
3. **Skull flower (骷髅花)** - A supernatural birthmark in the shape of a skull with flower patterns
4. **Eyes connecting yin and yang (目通阴阳)** - The ability to see both the world of the living and the world of spirits/ghosts
5. **Yin-yang eyes (阴阳眼)** - Supernatural sight that allows one to see ghosts and spirits invisible to normal people